

Week 1 Technical Fixes — Task Sheet

Six tasks, Monday to Thursday. Steps are in the email. This sheet is for ticking off and for the proof you send back each day.

6

TASKS

11.5 h

TOTAL TIME

4

DAYS

~3 h

PER DAY

THE SIX RULES — read before starting

1. Do Task 0, the backup, before anything else. Not optional.
2. Do only what is written. Do not fix anything else you notice.
3. Never deactivate a plugin, edit a code file, or touch Settings > Permalinks.
4. If a setting is not where described: screenshot what you see, send it, move on.
5. Take the proof screenshot after every task.
6. Send one message at the end of each day: one line per task, plus screenshots.

DAY 1 — MONDAY **3 hours**

Task	Time	What you are doing	Proof to send
☐ 0. Backup BLOCKING	15 min	UpdraftPlus → Backup Now. Tick both database and files. Wait for it to finish.	Screenshot of completed backup with today's date.
☐ 1. Fix robots.txt	45 min	Replace the file contents with the block in the email. Two lines are removed on purpose. First tell me which SEO plugin you found: Yoast, Rank Math, or neither.	Screenshot of marketeersresearch.com/robots.txt showing the new text.
☐ 2. Stop empty pages reaching Google	2 h	A: switch off photo/media pages. B: hide tag pages. C: set 5 named pages to "do not show in search results". The 5 pages: /career-form/ · /checklist-sign-up/ · /webinar-sign-up/ · /search-blog/ · /bnpl-study-yes/	Three screenshots: setting A, setting B, and the Advanced box on any one of the 5 pages showing "No".

DAY 2 — TUESDAY **2.5 hours**

Task	Time	What you are doing	Proof to send
☐ 3. Remove the date links from blog posts MOST IMPORTANT	2.5 h	The7 → Theme Options → Blog → Post Meta → switch Date off. Then clear the WP-Optimize cache <i>and</i> the Sucuri cache. Count matches for /blog/2026/ in the page source before and after. Before is usually 1 or 2. After must be 0.	Two screenshots: the match count before, and the match count after.

DAY 3 — WEDNESDAY **3 hours**

Task	Time	What you are doing	Proof to send
☐ 4. Make the images smaller	3 h	Install EWWW Image Optimizer (free, unlimited — not ShortPixel). Run Media → Bulk Optimize and leave it running. Meanwhile resize the 5 largest files to 1600px wide and convert the two PNG photos to JPG. Do not delete any original file. Upload the new versions and send me the new file names.	Screenshot of the finished Bulk Optimize screen showing images optimized and space saved, plus the 5 new file names.

DAY 4 — THURSDAY 3 hours

Task	Time	What you are doing	Proof to send
☐ 5. Fix 3 broken links	1.5 h	Install the Redirection plugin. Point <code>/data-analyst/</code> , <code>/careers-job-openings/</code> and <code>/digital-marketing-specialist/</code> all to <code>/careers/</code> as 301. Then find the Olive Oil PDF link and delete the stray <code>"</code> at the end of its address. Also copy me the two double-slash addresses. Report only — do not try to fix those.	Screenshot of the Redirection list showing all three, and the working PDF link.
☐ 6. Speed up the slow category pages STOP WHEN DONE	1.5 h	Time the page at httpstatus.io first. Then: WP-Optimize caching on, remove any cache exclusion containing "category" or "page", turn Preload on. Settings → Reading → 9 posts. Clear both caches. Time it again, twice.	The before time and the after time, screenshotted.

End of each day: one message with one line per task ("Task 3 — done" or "Task 3 — stuck"), the proof screenshots, and a list of anything you could not find. Send it even if a task is unfinished. Saying you are stuck is more useful than silence.

When to stop and message instead of continuing

If this happens	Do this
The backup fails or errors	Stop everything. Message immediately. Do not start Task 1.
You cannot find Yoast or Rank Math in the menu	Screenshot the left menu, send it, skip to Task 2.
You cannot find "The7" or the Date switch	Screenshot the screen you are on, send it, move to Day 3.
The date still shows after clearing both caches	Send both screenshots. Do not try anything else.
You cannot find the Olive Oil PDF link in 30 minutes	Stop looking. Say so in the message.
The category page is still slow after Task 6	Expected. Send the two times. A developer takes it from here.
Anything asks you to edit code or delete a plugin	Stop. That is never part of this week's work.

1 • The new robots.txt — replace everything with this

```
User-agent: *
Disallow: /wp-admin/
Allow: /wp-admin/admin-ajax.php
Disallow: /?s=
Disallow: /search/
Disallow: /?trk=
Disallow: /?clients=
Disallow: /?post_type=
Disallow: /?wordfence_logHuman=

Sitemap: https://marketeersresearch.com/wp-sitemap.xml
```

Removed on purpose: the line blocking `/wp-json/` and the line blocking `/sitemap-custom-posts.xml`. Do not put them back. Keep the blank line before Sitemap.

2 • The 5 pages to hide from Google (Task 2, Part C)

Page address	Where the setting lives
<code>/career-form/</code>	Open the page → scroll below the content to the SEO plugin box → Advanced tab → "Allow search engines to show this page in search results?" → set to No → Update. Rank Math wording: set Robots Meta to Custom, then tick No Index .
<code>/checklist-sign-up/</code>	
<code>/webinar-sign-up/</code>	
<code>/search-blog/</code>	
<code>/bnpl-study-yes/</code>	

3 • The 5 images to shrink by hand (Task 4, Step 3)

Search the Media Library for	Now	Do this
<code>cloud-storage-banner-background</code>	1.30 MB	Resize to 1600px wide
<code>Artboard-1teams.png</code>	1.27 MB	Resize to 1600px and convert to .jpg
<code>team.png</code>	823 KB	Resize to 1600px and convert to .jpg
<code>IMG-20221221-WA0183-1.jpg</code>	571 KB	Resize to 1600px wide
<code>data-information-report-statistics</code>	567 KB	Resize to 1600px wide

Free tools, no account needed: resize at iloveimg.com/resize-image, convert at iloveimg.com/convert-to-jpg. Never delete the original — upload the new file and send me its name.

4 • The 3 redirects to create (Task 5, Part B)

Source URL	Target URL	Type
<code>/data-analyst/</code>	<code>/careers/</code>	301 — Moved Permanently Currently points to <code>/data-analytics/</code> , which is wrong.
<code>/careers-job-openings/</code>	<code>/careers/</code>	301 — Moved Permanently
<code>/digital-marketing-specialist/</code>	<code>/careers/</code>	301 — Moved Permanently

5 · Report only — do not attempt

Copy these two addresses into Thursday's message. They have two slashes after `.com` and need a developer.

`marketeersresearch.com//blog/the-role-of-ai-data-analytics-in-fmcg-growth-a-roadmap-for-revenue-optimization/`

`marketeersresearch.com//blog/data-driven-growth-strategies-for-businesses-the-role-of-data-analytics-in-fmcg/`

6 · Clearing the cache — you must do both, every time

Where	How
WordPress	Left menu → WP-Optimize → Cache → Purge cache
Sucuri firewall	Log in → Clear cache

If you only clear one, the website keeps showing the old version and you will think the fix failed. This is the single most common reason a task looks like it did not work.